MEETING DATE: June 02, 2026
FROM: Chief David Maas, Police Department
RE: Consideration of early termination of the agreements for services between Flock Safety and the Town of Grand Chute
TYPE: New Business

Background Information: In February of 2023, the Town of Grand Chute entered into an agreement with Flock Safety for the installation and servicing of 20 fixed-point ALPR cameras within the Town. In June of 2024, the Town added a movable ALPR camera through a partnership with the Outagamie County Sheriff's Department. In November of 2025, the Town expanded the network through the addition of 3 new fixed-point cameras. Since that time, the department has opted not to renew the June 2024 agreement and returned the movable ALPR camera to Flock. Below is a summation of our agreements with Flock:

Contract Start	Contract End	Duration	Number of Units	Annual Cost
05/19/2023	05/18/2027	4 years	20	$52,500
06/27/2024	06/26/2026	2 years	1	Not Renewed
04/08/2026	04/07/2027	1 year	3	$9,000
			Total Annual Cost	**$61,500**

In February 2025, we identified abnormal system downtime and initiated support tickets for 18 of our 20 cameras. Downtime issues were determined to have begun as early as January 17, 2025 and had not been addressed by Flock. Six of the cameras were scheduled for replacement, which did not occur within the timeframe established by the vendor. In May of 2025, we requested and later received a statement credit from Flock to compensate for the unacceptable downtime of the network.

In April 2025, we were notified by WisDOT about an impending construction conflict with one of our Flock cameras. Flock was notified of this issue and provided information for the relocation of the camera. The camera was not relocated and we were notified by the contractor in July that it needed to be relocated immediately. The camera was removed by Flock over the July 4th weekend, but was not reinstalled. During the subsequent months, we were provided a number of different reasons why the camera had not been reinstalled, including issues with permitting, utility locates, and supply chain issues. The responses appeared to regularly change depending upon the representative we spoke with. On October 29, 2025, this camera was finally reinstalled. We again requested, and received, a statement credit from Flock to compensate for the unacceptable downtime.

On December 8, 2025, we identified abnormal system downtime and initiated support tickets for 7 of our 20 cameras that were failing. Those issues were resolved approximately one month later.

At the same time these service issues were plaguing our network, a public conversation was occurring about both the fixed-point ALPR technology and how Flock chose to structure their

services. In August 2025, news reporting revealed that federal immigration agents had direct access to police data through a pilot program, which allegedly contradicted nine months of denials. In other reporting, Flock CEO Garett Langley was quoted as addressing this issue with the following statements: “[T]here have been conflicting reports in the media about Flock's relationship with federal agencies, and some of our public statements inadvertently provided inaccurate information” and “We clearly communicated poorly. We also didn't create distinct permissions and protocols in the Flock system to ensure local compliance for federal agency users.”

Around this same time, Flock made significant changes in how external agency searches appeared in our system audit logs. While we previously had visibility to each search of our data and the associated reason behind it, Flock changed their systems to make it far more difficult to audit and verify the appropriateness of external agency searches. This feedback was provided to Flock, yet they refused to reverse course. In response, we removed our agency from “National Lookup” and discontinued sharing relationships with every agency outside the State of Wisconsin. In addition, we have frequently demanded that Flock institute internal controls to restrict external agency searches to only those that comply with our internal policy. As of this time, they have still failed to take action on these concerns. This creates an environment where some external agency searches might not comply with our internal policy related to ALPR acceptable use.

In October 2025, we began working with Axon to explore an alternative to Flock for fixed-point ALPR services. Our exploration of this solution has included a detailed analysis of the functionality of the system, along with an examination of Axon’s approach to the protection of personal privacy and data security. In addition, we have conducted our own test and evaluation of the equipment in order to ensure that the information provided by vendor representatives matched real-world performance. Over the past eight months, we have met extensively with Axon representatives to ensure that any transition was well-researched and provided significant benefit to our residents.

Our exploration of Axon’s solution had been done in anticipation of a transition at the end of our current agreement with Flock (May 2027). However, recent events and ongoing concerns have caused us to reconsider that course of action. Therefore, we are now requesting consideration to terminate our current agreement with Flock.

Over the past few months, concerns about Flock have been openly discussed in communities across Wisconsin. More locally, concerns were widely circulated prior to a proposed contract renewal in the City of Oshkosh. As the contract renewal was discussed, Flock representatives provided information which was later found to be inaccurate. This caused individuals to lose trust in Flock and, although the contract extension was initially approved in Oshkosh, the council ultimately reversed course and opted not to renew the contract. Flock’s response to the incident included a statement which read, in part: “It’s disappointing to hear that one small misconception

stated during a two-hour meeting, after many other meetings with Oshkosh's leaders and Police command staff, has resulted in this outcome."

Following the reversal in the City of Oshkosh, Appleton Mayor Jake Woodford announced that the City of Appleton would cease their agreement with Flock. In his announcement, Mayor Woodford stated "[t]hat being said, concerns about the integrity of Flock's underlying system have eroded our trust." What is important to note is that both Mayor Woodford and some elected officials in Oshkosh have vocalized support for fixed-point ALPR technology, alongside their concerns about Flock. This has been a common sentiment I've heard from other leaders and members of the public.

Our experience with Flock in 2025 included significant challenges associated with service of our equipment. Information provided by Flock representatives changed frequently and, at its best, could be described as inaccurate. After the August 2025 news reporting regarding federal immigration agents' access to Flock data, Flock provided a statement that they had provided inaccurate information in a very public forum. Fast forward to the recent events in Oshkosh and we see, once again, inaccurate information coming from Flock. While Flock's response to the Oshkosh events characterizes the issue as "one small misconception", it seems there may be a pattern of inaccuracies, which causes significant concern. Fixed-point ALPR technology is powerful and must be used responsibly. We must be able to fully trust any vendor we do business with, especially one that provides such a powerful tool. The pattern of inaccuracies serves to erode trust, which cannot be ignored.

Attorney Rossmeissl has reviewed the Flock agreement and the termination for convenience provisions therein.

Fiscal Impact: The early termination of the Flock agreement would result in a removal fee being assessed of $500 per camera. When multiplied across 23 active cameras, the termination fee would total $11,500. In addition, there is a non-refundable component of the agreement for advanced search features, which is outlined in the below table. Upon termination, the Town would receive a pro-rated refund for Flock hardware, which is estimated as follows:

Term Start	Term End	Duration	Daily Rate	Fee Owed	Fee Paid	Refund Due
05/19/2026	06/03/2026	16 days	$137	$2,192	$52,500	$50,308
04/08/2026	06/03/2026	57 days	$25	$1,425	$9,000	$7,575
Subtotals				**$3,617**	**$61,500**	**$57,883**
			Non-Refundable (Advanced Search)			-$2,500
			Early Termination Removal Fee			-$11,500
					Estimated Total Refund	**$43,883**

The Flock agreements were funded through two sources; the department operating budget and donated funds. The operating budget supported $52,500 of the overall cost, whereas the donations supported $9,000.

Recommended Action: Motion to terminate all agreements for services between Flock Safety and the Town of Grand Chute.

Attachments:

1. Flock Safety Agreement for Services